

August 13, 2026

Humana
Provider Correspondence
P.O. Box 14601
Lexington, KY 40512

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Jed Pollich (MRN MUSC6746441), Claim MUSC-72D8-2

Patient	Jed Pollich (DOB 1968-03-01)
MRN	MUSC6746441
Member ID / Group	HUM343732532 / GRP-55180
Claim number	MUSC-72D8-2
Date of service	2026-06-04
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$835.76
Denial code	CARC 197 / RARC N54 — Precertification/authorization/notification/pre-treatment absent.
Appeal deadline	2026-08-29

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal first-level appeal on behalf of patient Jed Pollich (MRN: MUSC6746441, Member ID: HUM343732532) regarding the denial of Claim ID MUSC-72D8-2 for services rendered on June 4, 2026, by Robert K. Lindqvist, MD (NPI 1314059687) at MUSC Health University Medical Center. The claim was submitted on June 9, 2026, and denied on June 30, 2026, in the total billed amount of \$835.76. Humana cited CARC 197 — "Precertification/authorization/notification/pre-treatment absent" — and RARC N54 — "Claim information is inconsistent with pre-certified/authorized services" — with the accompanying payer remark: "No prior authorization on file for the date of service billed." MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and requests full reimbursement of the allowed amount of \$432.87.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Pollich is a 58-year-old male with an established and complex medical history managed at MUSC Health. His active conditions include hypertension, hyperlipidemia, anemia, prediabetes, obesity, chronic sinusitis, and a documented history of seizure disorder with prior EEG evaluation. He carries an active secondary diagnosis of G40.909, reflecting his ongoing seizure-related condition first identified in 2014. His current medication regimen includes Hydrochlorothiazide and Simvastatin, consistent with his chronic disease burden. The June 4, 2026 encounter was billed under CPT 99214 — an established outpatient visit of moderate complexity — with a primary diagnosis of J06.9 (acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified) and secondary diagnosis of G40.909. Given the patient's multiple active comorbidities, a moderate-complexity evaluation and management service is clinically consistent with the documented scope of care.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial rests solely on the assertion that no prior authorization was on file for the date of service. MUSC Health contends that CPT 99214, when rendered as an established-patient outpatient evaluation and management visit, does not routinely require prior authorization under standard commercial and Medicare Advantage plan structures for office and outpatient services. Evaluation and management services provided to established patients are widely recognized as routine, ongoing care that payers do not customarily subject to prospective authorization requirements. To the extent Humana's plan documents impose such a requirement for this service type, MUSC Health requests that Humana identify the specific benefit provision and authorization requirement applicable to CPT 99214 in the outpatient setting, as this is not a surgical procedure, advanced imaging study, or other service category for which prior authorization is a standard expectation.

Furthermore, the secondary diagnosis of G40.909 — an active, chronic neurological condition — underscores that this visit involved management of ongoing medical complexity beyond an acute upper respiratory complaint, further supporting the medical necessity and appropriateness of the 99214 level of service. The patient's longitudinal conditions, including seizure disorder, hypertension, hyperlipidemia, and prediabetes, are consistent with the moderate complexity required for this billing level.

MUSC Health also notes that Mr. Pollich's coverage period runs through December 31, 2026, and that the service was rendered well within the active coverage window. There is no indication of eligibility-related issues contributing to this denial.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Humana conduct a complete review of this appeal and overturn the denial of Claim ID MUSC-72D8-2. Specifically, we request that Humana confirm whether CPT 99214 for an established outpatient patient is subject to prior authorization under this plan, and if so, provide the applicable plan language. If no such requirement applies, we request that the claim be reprocessed and payment issued at the contracted allowed amount of \$432.87. Should Humana uphold the denial, we request a written explanation identifying the precise authorization requirement and the benefit provision under which it applies, in accordance with applicable Medicare Advantage reconsideration and commercial appeal-rights obligations.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
(843) 792-2300 | muschealth.org

Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record